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Dear Hiring Team at GXN,

I trained as an architect in Brazil and spent years on the execution side of the work, the drawings, the coordination, the delivery. What pulled me away were the questions a studio rarely stops on. What is this made of, what does that cost the world, and could it be done better. Few of the offices I worked in could answer those with evidence rather than instinct, so I went looking for one that could and found CITA at The Royal Danish Academy.

It was through CITA that I came to know your work from the inside. We ran a workshop with GXN and spent a week in your office, where I developed the geospatial mappings of local material sources and supply flows for the Matanzas project. The rammed blue biomass composite I developed in a semester project became the material foundation for the Venice Biennale installation presented with CITA, GXN and 3XN. People from GXN also came through the school regularly, sitting on juries and running smaller workshops. What struck me across all of it was that GXN treats data and computation as a normal part of how buildings get made, which is precisely what I had been missing in practice.

I build those tools myself. At Isay Weinfeld I wrote a Grasshopper plugin in Python that generates bespoke staircases from a floor plan, cutting modeling from days to around twenty minutes. I presented it in a studio workshop and colleagues adopted it across more than ten projects. What made it worth building was not the geometry, it was what people started attempting once iterating became cheap.

The environmental side has run alongside it, and quantitatively. With a Copenhagen LCA startup I delivered a Revit-based embodied carbon toolkit, integrating GWP values for A1-A3 and A4 into a schedule architects could actually adopt. At Ramboll I mapped the global supply chains of more than twenty critical raw materials under the EU Critical Raw Materials Act.

What stayed with me from that week was less the project than the way people worked, research and making treated as one activity rather than two departments. That is the practice I have been working toward since I stepped away from the drawing side of architecture.

All the best,

Antonio Carmagnani